

Sifan Li

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About Me

I am currently a Ph.D. candidate at the Institute of Computing Technology, Chinese Academy of Sciences. I am also a research intern at Shanghai AI Lab and the University of California, Merced, working under the supervision of Dr. Yiwei Wang.

My research interests include NLP, multimodal LLMs, VLMs, AI interpretability, agentic systems, reinforcement learning, AI4Science, efficient training, computer vision, *etc.*

Employments

Shanghai Artificial Intelligence Laboratory Assistant Researcher in AI4S	April 2026 – Now
University of California, Merced Research Intern advised by Asst. Prof. Yiwei Wang	Sept. 2024 – Now
vivo Mobile Communication Co., Ltd. Assistant Algorithm Engineer in NLP	June 2025 – April 2026
Peking University Visiting Student advised by Asst. Prof. Hao Tang	June 2024 – June 2025
Hong Kong University of Science and Technology (Guangzhou) Research Assistant advised by Asst. Prof. Bingzhuo Zhong, Dr. rer. nat.	Dec. 2023 – Dec. 2024

Education

Institute of Computing Technology, Chinese Academy of Sciences Doctor of Philosophy in Computer Science	Sept. 2026 – Now
Liaoning University Master of Science in Computer Science	Sept. 2023 – June 2026
Shenyang Jianzhu University Bachelor of Engineering in Computer Science and Technology	Sept. 2017 – June 2021

Publications

- [1] **Sifan Li**, Yujun Cai, Hongkai Chen, and Yiwei Wang. GeoSVG-RL: Geometry-Aware Reinforcement Learning for Layout-Constrained Text-to-SVG Diagram Generation. 2026. *arXiv preprint*: <https://arxiv.org/abs/2605.25447>.
- [2] **Sifan Li**, Hongkai Chen, Yujun Cai, Liyang Chen, Qingwen Ye, and Yiwei Wang. OptiSQL: Executable SQL Generation from Optical Tokens. 2026. *arXiv preprint*: <https://arxiv.org/abs/2601.13695>.
- [3] **Sifan Li**, Yujun Cai, and Yiwei Wang. 2025. SemVink: Advancing VLMs' Semantic Understanding of Optical Illusions via Visual Global Thinking. In *Proceedings of the 2025 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing*, pages 27155–27165, Suzhou, China. Association for Computational Linguistics. (<https://aclanthology.org/2025.emnlp-main.1381/>). (**Oral Presentation in the Main Conference of EMNLP 2025.**)
- [4] **Sifan Li**, Hongkai Chen, Yujun Cai, Qingwen Ye, Liyang Chen, Junsong Yuan, and Yiwei Wang. Vision

Language Models Map Logos to Text via Semantic Entanglement in the Visual Projector. 2025. *arXiv preprint*: <https://arxiv.org/abs/2510.12287>.

- [5] **Sifan Li**, Yujun Cai, Bryan Hooi, Nanyun Peng, and Yiwei Wang. Do “New Snow Tablets” Contain Snow? Large Language Models Over-Rely on Names to Identify Ingredients of Chinese Drugs. 2025. *arXiv preprint*: <https://arxiv.org/abs/2504.03786>.
- [6] **Sifan Li**, Ming Tao, Hao Zhao, Ling Shao, and Hao Tang. Replace in Translation: Boost Concept Alignment in Counterfactual Text-to-Image. 2025. *arXiv preprint*: <https://arxiv.org/abs/2505.14341>.
- [7] Yun Liu, **Sifan Li**, Huiyu Duan, Daoxin Fan, and Guangtao Zhai. MMIFN: A Multi-Modal Interactive Fusion Network for Omnidirectional Image Quality Assessment. In *IEEE Transactions on Multimedia*, Early Access, pp. 1-12, 2026, doi: <https://doi.org/10.1109/TMM.2026.3700770>. (**First student author.**)
- [8] Yun Liu, **Sifan Li**, Daoxin Fan, Huiyu Duan, and Peiguang Jing. TFFN: Three-Branch Feature Fusion Network for Stereoscopic Omnidirectional Image Quality Assessment. In *IEEE Transactions on Multimedia*, Early Access, pp. 1-12, 2026, doi: <https://doi.org/10.1109/TMM.2026.3664949>. (**First student author.**)
- [9] Yun Liu, **Sifan Li**, Zihan Liu, Haiyuan Wang, and Daoxin Fan. BPGI: A Brain-Perception Guided Interactive Network for Stereoscopic Omnidirectional Image Quality Assessment. In *IEEE Open Journal on Immersive Displays*, vol. 2, pp. 81-88, 2025, doi: <https://doi.org/10.1109/OJID.2025.3610449>. (**First student author.**)
- [10] Yun Liu, **Sifan Li**, Huiyu Duan, Yu Zhou, Daoxin Fan, and Guangtao Zhai. Multi-Task Guided No-Reference Omnidirectional Image Quality Assessment With Feature Interaction. In *IEEE Transactions on Circuits and Systems for Video Technology*, vol. 35, no. 9, pp. 8794-8806, 2025, doi: <https://doi.org/10.1109/TCSVT.2025.3551723>. (**First student author.**)
- [11] Liyang Chen, Hongkai Chen, Yujun Cai, **Sifan Li**, Qingwen Ye, and Yiwei Wang. AudioRouter: Data Efficient Audio Understanding via RL based Dual Reasoning. 2026. *arXiv preprint*: <https://arxiv.org/abs/2602.10439>.
- [12] Liyang Chen, Hongkai Chen, Yujun Cai, **Sifan Li**, Qingwen Ye, and Yiwei Wang. Detecting and Mitigating Insertion Hallucination in Video-to-Audio Generation. 2025. *arXiv preprint*: <https://arxiv.org/abs/2510.08078>.
- [13] Yun Liu, Zhipeng Wen, **Sifan Li**, Daoxin Fan, and Guangtao Zhai. Image Aesthetics Assessment Based on Visual Perception and Textual Semantic Understanding. In *Digital Multimedia Communications*, pp. 39-53, 2024, doi: https://doi.org/10.1007/978-981-97-3626-3_4.
- [14] Yun Liu, Zhipeng Wen, Minzhu Jin, Daoxin Fan, **Sifan Li**, Bo Liu, Jinhe Jiang, and Xianda Xiao. A Multimodal Fake News Detection Model with Self-supervised Unimodal Label Generation. In *Advanced Intelligent Computing Technology and Applications*, pp. 130-141, 2024, doi: https://doi.org/10.1007/978-981-97-5603-2_11.

Serving as (Senior) Area Chair

Association for the Advancement of Artificial Intelligence (AAAI)	2026
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Serving as Reviewer

Association for the Advancement of Artificial Intelligence (AAAI)	2027
Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)	2026
Conference on Language Modeling (COLM)	2026
Association for the Advancement of Artificial Intelligence (AAAI)	2026
IEEE/CVF Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (CVPR)	2025